GUIDANCE NOTE 02

Engineering Certification — What We Look For

Usually one element missing, rather than the whole document.

Most engineering we receive is fine. When we do come back on it, it is almost always a single missing element rather than a missing document — and almost always one of the items below.

WHAT WE NEED TO SEE

- ✓ The engineer's name, company and registration number
- ✓ Signed **and** dated
- ✓ The wind region and terrain category the design is based on
- ✓ Site classification where the design depends on it
- ✓ The specific structure and address, or clearly matched to them
- ✓ Footing details — depth, diameter, and reinforcement
- ✓ Tie-down and bracing details
- ✓ Any conditions or limits the engineer has set

COMMON REASONS WE COME BACK

- ✗ Generic manufacturer's engineering not matched to the wind region for the site
- ✗ Undated, or dated before the design it certifies
- ✗ Certification covering a different span, height or roof load than the plans show
- ✗ A condition set in the engineering that the drawings don't reflect
- ✗ A page missing from a multi-page set

WHAT AN ACCEPTABLE CERTIFICATION SAYS

- "Designed in accordance with AS 1170.2 for Wind Region A, Terrain Category 2."
- "Footings: 450 mm diameter × 900 mm deep, N12 bar as detailed."
- "Maximum span 6.0 m. Not suitable for spans exceeding this without further advice."
- "This certification applies to the structure shown on drawing 24-0198 rev C, dated 14 May 2026."
- Signed, dated, with the engineer's name and registration number below the signature.

If the engineering sets a condition, make sure the plans show it. A minimum footing depth or a maximum span in the engineering has to appear on the drawings too — we check one against the other.

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